Master Circular on Operational Resilience of Core Banking and Payment Systems

Ref: SYN/UCB/OPS/2026-01 (synthetic)

1 Introduction

This circular sets out the baseline operational resilience expectations for the core banking and digital payment systems operated by the bank. It is issued for internal operational reference only and is entirely synthetic.

1.1 Applicability

These expectations apply to all customer-facing transactional services, including core banking, UPI/IMPS retail payments, NEFT/RTGS interbank transfers, and ATM/card switching, whether operated on-premises or as a hosted/shared service.

1.2 Scope

The scope covers availability monitoring, incident reporting timelines, business-continuity posture, and the change-control discipline required for tier-1 services. Connectivity to the sponsor commercial bank and to the national payment infrastructure is explicitly in scope.

2 Operational Resilience

The bank shall maintain continuous monitoring of all tier-1 services and their supporting configuration items, including the sponsor-bank link and the NPCI link through which retail payment settlement flows.

2.1 Availability Targets

Retail digital payment rails operate on a 24x7 basis and shall be monitored accordingly. Branch-hours services may follow branch operating windows.

2.2 Dependency Mapping

Each tier-1 service shall have a documented dependency map identifying the configuration items on which it depends, so that the operational impact of any single component failure can be assessed promptly.

3 Incident Management

Material operational incidents affecting customer transactions shall be triaged, escalated, and recorded. The reporting window and the precise escalation matrix are defined in the bank's internal incident SOP.

3.1 Classification

Incidents shall be classified by customer impact and by the tier of the affected service. A failure of the sponsor-bank link that blocks UPI/IMPS settlement is, by definition, a tier-1 incident.

3.2 Reporting Timeline

Reportable incidents shall be notified to the relevant authority within the stipulated window. (Exact hour-counts are deliberately omitted from this synthetic fixture and must be confirmed against current regulation.)

4 Business Continuity

Each tier-1 service shall have a defined disaster-recovery node and a tested failover procedure. Recovery objectives shall be documented and exercised periodically as part of the BCP programme.

4.1 Disaster Recovery

A tier-1 service with no mapped DR node is considered to violate the expected business-continuity posture and shall be flagged for remediation.

5 Conclusion

Adherence to these baseline expectations is intended to keep customer-facing services resilient. This document is synthetic and for test use only.

1 Introduction (cont. 2)

This circular sets out the baseline operational resilience expectations for the core banking and digital payment systems operated by the bank. It is issued for internal operational reference only and is entirely synthetic.

1.1 Applicability (cont. 2)

These expectations apply to all customer-facing transactional services, including core banking, UPI/IMPS retail payments, NEFT/RTGS interbank transfers, and ATM/card switching, whether operated on-premises or as a hosted/shared service.

1.2 Scope (cont. 2)

The scope covers availability monitoring, incident reporting timelines, business-continuity posture, and the change-control discipline required for tier-1 services. Connectivity to the sponsor commercial bank and to the national payment infrastructure is explicitly in scope.

2 Operational Resilience (cont. 2)

The bank shall maintain continuous monitoring of all tier-1 services and their supporting configuration items, including the sponsor-bank link and the NPCI link through which retail payment settlement flows.

2.1 Availability Targets (cont. 2)

Retail digital payment rails operate on a 24x7 basis and shall be monitored accordingly. Branch-hours services may follow branch operating windows.

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Each tier-1 service shall have a defined disaster-recovery node and a tested failover procedure. Recovery objectives shall be documented and exercised periodically as part of the BCP programme.

4.1 Disaster Recovery (cont. 2)

A tier-1 service with no mapped DR node is considered to violate the expected business-continuity posture and shall be flagged for remediation.

5 Conclusion (cont. 2)

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1 Introduction (cont. 3)

This circular sets out the baseline operational resilience expectations for the core banking and digital payment systems operated by the bank. It is issued for internal operational reference only and is entirely synthetic.

1.1 Applicability (cont. 3)

These expectations apply to all customer-facing transactional services, including core banking, UPI/IMPS retail payments, NEFT/RTGS interbank transfers, and ATM/card switching, whether operated on-premises or as a hosted/shared service.

1.2 Scope (cont. 3)

The scope covers availability monitoring, incident reporting timelines, business-continuity posture, and the change-control discipline required for tier-1 services. Connectivity to the sponsor commercial bank and to the national payment infrastructure is explicitly in scope.

2 Operational Resilience (cont. 3)

The bank shall maintain continuous monitoring of all tier-1 services and their supporting configuration items, including the sponsor-bank link and the NPCI link through which retail payment settlement flows.

2.1 Availability Targets (cont. 3)

Retail digital payment rails operate on a 24x7 basis and shall be monitored accordingly. Branch-hours services may follow branch operating windows.

2.2 Dependency Mapping (cont. 3)

Each tier-1 service shall have a documented dependency map identifying the configuration items on which it depends, so that the operational impact of any single component failure can be assessed promptly.

3 Incident Management (cont. 3)

Material operational incidents affecting customer transactions shall be triaged, escalated, and recorded. The reporting window and the precise escalation matrix are defined in the bank's internal incident SOP.

3.1 Classification (cont. 3)

Incidents shall be classified by customer impact and by the tier of the affected service. A failure of the sponsor-bank link that blocks UPI/IMPS settlement is, by definition, a tier-1 incident.

3.2 Reporting Timeline (cont. 3)

Reportable incidents shall be notified to the relevant authority within the stipulated window. (Exact hour-counts are deliberately omitted from this synthetic fixture and must be confirmed against current regulation.)

4 Business Continuity (cont. 3)

Each tier-1 service shall have a defined disaster-recovery node and a tested failover procedure. Recovery objectives shall be documented and exercised periodically as part of the BCP programme.

4.1 Disaster Recovery (cont. 3)

A tier-1 service with no mapped DR node is considered to violate the expected business-continuity posture and shall be flagged for remediation.

5 Conclusion (cont. 3)

Adherence to these baseline expectations is intended to keep customer-facing services resilient. This document is synthetic and for test use only.